



▲ ASSYRIAN SAPPARA

Date c.1300BCE

Origin Assyria

Length 51.3cm (20¹/₄in)

The *sappara*, or sickle-sword, was a characteristic weapon of the Assyrian foot soldier. This one has a cuneiform inscription, indicating that it may have belonged to the Assyrian ruler Adad-nirari I (r.1307–1275BCE).



Blue lapis lazuli hilt

Triangular head

Raised groove

Long tang (shaft)

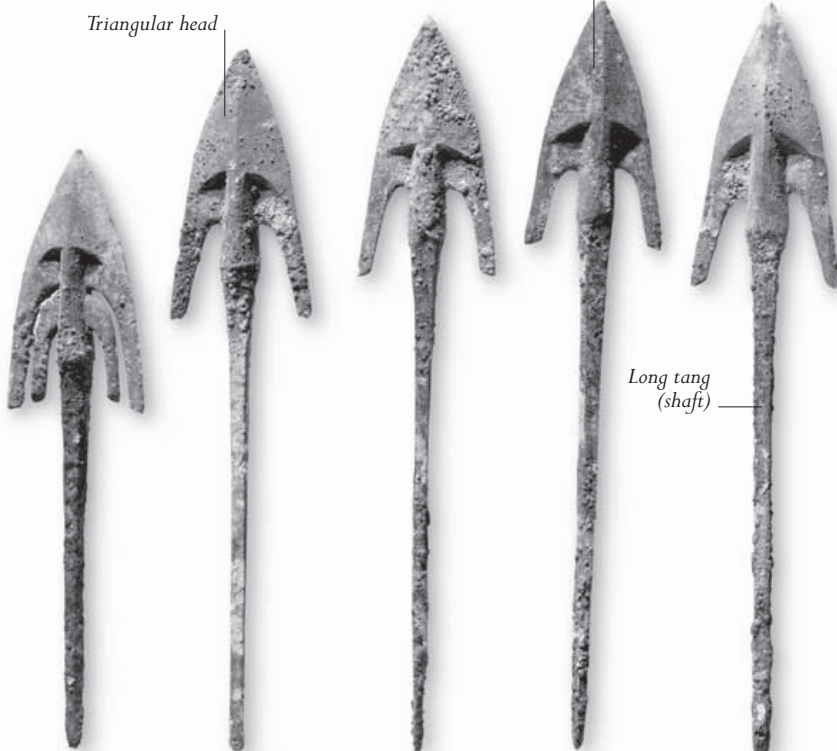
◀ CAUCASIAN ARROWHEADS

Date c.1000BCE

Origin Southern Caucasus

Length Up to 17.1cm (6³/₄in)

Large numbers of cast-bronze arrowheads have been excavated in the southern Caucasus. They suggest that the armies of the peoples of this area, to the north of Assyria, relied heavily on archers.



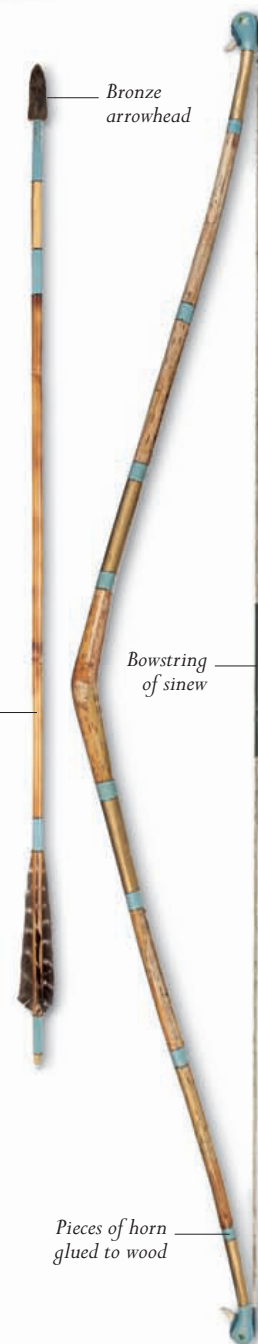
► ASSYRIAN BOW AND ARROW

Date c.750BCE

Origin Assyria

Length (Bow) 1.42m (4³/₄ft)

Archers formed the main part of the Assyrian infantry. They operated in pairs – one man acting as a shield-bearer, while the other used a bow, such as this one, a replica made from horn, sinew, and wood.



Pieces of horn glued to wood

► ASSYRIAN ARROWHEADS

Date c.700BCE

Origin Assyria

Length 3cm (1in)

These heavily corroded iron arrowheads were found at the Judaeen town of Lachish, captured by the Assyrians after a brutal siege in 701BCE. Assyrian bows could have a range of more than 250m (820ft).



◀ PERSIAN AKINAKES

Date 550–350BCE

Origin Persia

Length 34cm (13¹/₂in)

Along with spears, infantrymen also carried *akinakes* – a short, thrusting sword used for close-quarter combat – worn on their right side. High officials are frequently depicted wearing them in Persian art.

